I'm Not Stupid

By David E Rodriguez

MA: These are the words of my son

DR. GREEN: My patient

BOTH: Roger.

INTRODUCTION

During the Intro, both Characters speak as "Roger," a mentally disabled young boy:

MA: *I was watching the Little Rascals on TV, they had a clubhouse . . .*

DR. GREEN: *and I wanted a big clubhouse like the Little Rascals' . . .*

MA: *I'm not stupid! You need WOOD to build a clubhouse, and there is a lot of wood in the junkyard.*

DR. GREEN: *I could get wood from the junkyard to make me a little house like the Little Rascals'.*

MA: *I was going to sleep in it, and Pa too.*

DR. GREEN: *We were going to sleep in the clubhouse like the Little Rascals.*

MA: *I went to the junkyard and got a lot of wood. . .*

DR. GREEN: *I'm not stupid! You need nails, I had a lot of nails. . .*

MA: *and you need a box, you build it like a big box, but it's turned upside down . . .*

DR.GREEN: *I'm not stupid! I could make a clubhouse,*

MA: *you need a hammer for the nails. Pa had a hammer, he had a big hammer.*

DR. GREEN: *Like this big.*

MA: *It was in the house. . . and I went into the house to get the big hammer.*

DR. GREEN: *I asked Ma for Pa's hammer.*

MA: *She started to cry.*

DR. GREEN: *She told me Pa wasn't coming back.*

MA: *I'm not stupid! I know Pa was dead*

BOTH: *"I'm Not Stupid"*

DR.GREEN: *By David E Rodriguez*

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MA: *(drunk, but not noticeably so)* Dr. Green?

DR. GREEN: Good afternoon, Mrs. Fletcher. Please pardon this intrusion. I tried calling, but your phone is out of order. Your son Roger didn't keep his appointment. Do you know where he is or if he left?

MA: He's at the junkyard.

DR. GREEN: This is most peculiar. All the years I have known him, he has never missed an appointment.

MA: Wait for him here. He'll be right back, and I do have to talk to you.

DR. GREEN: I see. Then I'll wait. *(He takes a seat.)* So, what is on your mind?

MA: I was thinking about that question you asked me, if I loved Roger. And I've been thinking; I love Roger. It's the kind of love you have for a pet. . . a dog, maybe. You give it a bath, feed it, clean up after it. Don't get me wrong, Dr. Green, did you expect me to love him as a son? How can I? He can't do anything, except eat and sleep, like a dog. I'm not mean. That does not make me mean. Did you ever wonder if a dog loves? I say that people say that dogs love, but that is just because you take care of it. They'll go back to sleep until they're hungry again, and then come back for more. They don't know where the food comes from, as long as it tastes good. They'll eat it, then they'll go back to sleep. . . Roger sleeps a lot. In a way, Roger isn't a person. He's a dog. You give him what he wants, and he stays happy, right? That's right! It's true! So why should I love him as a son, when he's a dog. Don't look at me like that, Dr. Green, you know what I'm saying is true. Why don't you just put away all that mumbo jumbo about a person is a person, and wake up and see that Roger is really a dog, that talks. A talking, walking, big ol' dumb dog, and maybe you could understand what I'm saying. So you can stop looking at me like that! I'm not stupid, I'm smart. Do you think I'm smart? I think I'm smart, this is

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my opinion. It is my opinion that Roger is a dog. So what? What's so wrong with that? Kill me, for cryin' out loud, but at least I loved him. I kept him happy. No, I mean, I love him and I keep him happy. Sometimes I mix words around, but I'm still smart, and he's still happy. So you see, there's nothing wrong. Roger would even tell you himself, and he will when he comes back, you'll see.

DR. GREEN: I can't believe you just said that. He's your son.

MA: No, he is not. He's no son of mine.

DR. GREEN: No? What is he to you, then?

MA: He's just this stupid, good-for-nothing that took everything I ever lived for!

DR. GREEN: That is not true!

MA: It's true! Since the day he was born I no longer had a husband. Now he's dead because of him.

DR. GREEN: It was a heart attack. Blaming Roger

MA: *(interrupting)* Henry was strong! He worked day in and day out to pay doctor bills. . . *Doctor!* He'd come home tired every night. . . . So tired and pale, Dr. Green. How long do you think a man could last doing that without one day his body giving in? I saw it. I told him to stop. I told him to send Roger away so he wouldn't have to work so hard. But no, he loved Roger. That man gave more love to that idiot than he gave me in seventeen years!

DR. GREEN: I see. So what are you going to do now? Make him suffer? Treat him as if he were some kind of animal? What do you want?

MA: I want what I deserve!

DR. GREEN: And what is that? Money?

MA: It isn't about the damn money!

DR. GREEN: Okay. . . . What, then? . . . What? *(Pause.)*

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MA: If you don't like the way I treat him, why don't you have him sent away? *(Pause.)*

DR. GREEN: *(They overlap for next few lines.)* This is all about the money. . .

MA: You're wrong. . .

DR. GREEN: We both know that if Roger is sent away, you'll be awarded his trust money. . .

MA: I want to go on with my life. . .

DR. GREEN: . . . I won't be able to provide services for him; thus I will no longer oversee the account. . .

MA: . . . I deserve some peace. . .

DR. GREEN: . . . making you the beneficiary of your husband's will, isn't that right? What else could it be? *(Overlapping ends.)*

MA: You don't know everything, you have no idea!

DR. GREEN: Come now, Mrs. Fletcher, you said it yourself, he's not your son. All Roger is, is one big dollar sign.

MA: He's an idiot. He's never going to get married and have kids. He's never going to have a job, much less take care of me when I get old. I'm lonely, even if Roger is around. Maybe. . . maybe I should get a real dog or something, what do you think? I'll bathe it, take it for walks, clean up after it. I have had years of experience. . .

DR. GREEN: You're drunk.

MA: So I'm drunk, what does that have to do with it? I'll still feel the same when I'm sober. I'll still want a dog. . .

DR. GREEN: Mrs. Fletcher, I think we ought to talk about this again, when you sober up. Obviously you're not yourself. Until then, I will look for Roger. If you will excuse me

MA: No, stay here. Roger will come back. He's probably on his way and it's so

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cold outside.

DR. GREEN: I appreciate your concern, but I think I really ought to

MA: I gave him the hammer.

DR. GREEN: What?

MA: I did. After that, he went rushing out the door to the junkyard.

DR. GREEN: Well, that explains it. It was good of you, you know. You did something.

MA: I know I've been really hard on him for some time. You see, I'm not mean. I think I'm turning over a new leaf. I was just angry over Henry's death, that's all. Now, I'm over it.

DR. GREEN: Really?

MA: You say that as if you don't believe me. I may be drunk now, but this is the last time. I'm going to be a new woman, you'll see.

DR. GREEN: I see. A moment ago Roger was a dog.

MA: Oh, that. Really bad example, wasn't it?

DR. GREEN: I would say so, but

MA: You know, I never knew what the "K" stands for in "Dr. K Green. "

DR. GREEN: Karl.

MA: Karl-that's a nice name. Do you mind if I call you Karl?

DR. GREEN: If you prefer.

MA: I would. I don't know, "Dr. Green" sounds so formal. Don't you agree? So distant, and I would like us to be closer, Karl. Afer all, you'll be treating me.

DR. GREEN: Treating you?

MA: Yes, didn't I tell you? No, I didn't, did I?

DR. GREEN: I don't believe so.

MA: Well, now you know. I've decided to take you up on your offer. I figured some treatment will do me some good.

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DR. GREEN: I see.

MA: What's wrong, you don't want to treat me? I know, I'm blowing your mind, right? Oh, don't be surprised, Karl. I was on my bad side for a while like I said before, I'm over that now.

DR. GREEN: Well, then I think that Dr. Green would be more appropriate.

MA: Why?

DR. GREEN: I think it would make our relationship more professional. Now that you are under my care

MA: Oh, don't be such a stiffy? Wanna drink, while you wait? Oh, I forgot, doctors don't drink, right?

DR. GREEN: I don't know about other doctors, I don't.

MA: That's good. I wouldn't want you to either, Karl. Oops, I forgot! I'm sorry.

DR. GREEN: That's all right.

MA: Since you're here, maybe we can have my first session right now.

DR. GREEN: You've been drinking.

MA: Never mind, I'm sobering up already.

DR. GREEN: Really, Mrs. Fletcher.

MA: Call me Margaret, or is that not professional enough?

DR. GREEN: That's quite all right, if you prefer, but as I was saying before

MA: Yes, as you were saying, Dr. Green.

DR. GREEN: I think it would be more appropriate if I asked my secretary to make an appointment.

MA: There you go again, Mr. Stiffy. Do you always have to do things by the book? There's no bending you, is there?

DR. GREEN: I don't know. What do you mean?

MA: You know what I mean. Didn't you do anything wild and crazy when you

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were young?

DR. GREEN: Like what?

MA: You know, like play a practical joke on your friends, or steal the neighbor's dog? Play a big trick?

DR. GREEN: I have. Not that in particular, but yes, when I was young.

MA: That's what I mean. Come on, loosen up. Let's get a session going here.

DR. GREEN: All right, if you insist.

MA: Great. So what do I do now, lie down?

DR. GREEN: Whatever makes you feel comfortable.

MA: I'm comfortable. What do I do now?

DR. GREEN: Tell me what's on your mind.

MA: Where do I start?

DR. GREEN: Anywhere.

MA: I don't know, I feel funny. Give me a suggestion.

DR. GREEN: All right, why the sudden change in you?

MA: I told you, I'm letting go of the past.

DR. GREEN: Why?

MA: Why not? I can't stay bitter for the rest of my life. Now that Henry is gone, I'm over it. Why don't I start a new life with Roger? Have a chance to be a mother to him? After all, he is my son, isn't he? Forget all that nonsense about him being a dog. I do love him. I guess I've been denying it for so long. . . Well?

DR. GREEN: Well, what?

MA: Aren't you going to say something?

DR. GREEN: Like?

MA: Well, like, I think that you're making a change for the better.

DR. GREEN: I think you're making a change for the better.

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MA: You really mean that?

DR. GREEN: Honestly?

MA: Yes.

DR. GREEN: No, I don't believe one word you've said.

MA: What? I can't believe it!

DR. GREEN: I'm a psychiatrist, Mrs. Fletcher. I don't believe in miracles.

MA: But I'm telling the truth! I swear, He's at the junkyard! Who the hell do you think you are, calling me a liar!

DR. GREEN: When did you give him the hammer?

MA: Today! I gave it to him today!

DR. GREEN: What did you make him promise? What did he have to do?

MA: Nothing. Why are you doing this to me! I just wanted him to be happy.

DR. GREEN: How do you know he is at the junkyard?

MA: I took him there myself.

DR. GREEN: Really? Why?

MA: He wanted me to see them build his goddamn clubhouse!

DR. GREEN: Then why isn't he here now? Tell me! Why?

MA: What? What are you accusing me of? Do you think I'd go that far?

DR. GREEN: Go as far as what? GO AS FAR AS WHAT!!! WHAT DID YOU DO TO HIM?

MA: I'm changing, don't you see? I'm not lying! I swear!

DR. GREEN: I'm going to the junkyard.

MA: No!

DR. GREEN: Why not? I'm going, Mrs. Fletcher.

MA: *(Clings fiercely to him.)* Don't go-please, please don't go! He's there! Believe what I'm saying! He's there!

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DR. GREEN: Let go of me! Let go of me!

MA: All right, all right, go then! Go! (DR. GREEN *exits.)* You think you know everything! Go!

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: David E Rodriguez
Book: Telling Tales: New One Act Plays
ISBN: 978-0140482379
Publisher: Penguin
Date (Month/Year): March 1993

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